

Seven Tips for Staying Motivated and Managing Stress During Your Job Search ▼



The job search process can be challenging, regardless of what industry you are aiming to enter. It often involves uncertainty, rejection, and long waiting periods. Despite the challenges associated with this process, there are many ways to stay motivated and manage stress effectively. Here are seven tips to help you navigate the job search process with confidence and resilience.

1: Set Goals

With the job/internship search process, it is important to go into it with goals in mind. You want to ask yourself some guiding

questions about what you hope to gain and what your motivations are. That includes questions like:

- *Do I have a certain employer that I want to connect with?*
- *What benefits or compensation are important to me?*
- *What values, skills, interests, and strengths do I bring to the table?*
- *What kind of company culture would be ideal for me?*
- *How important is a healthy work-life balance or a flexible work environment?*

Then once you've asked yourself these guiding questions, it's time to set goals. A goal is a desired end result of a certain action. Some goals you could have related to the job search process are:

- *I want to work for a company that does [specific function / initiative / project].*
- *I want to work for a company that provides [benefit/ program/ resource/ job component or responsibility/ feature].*
- *I will apply for jobs in [industry] that allows me to do [XYZ].*
- *I will reach out to [number] of connections on LinkedIn to pursue job leads.*

Creating actionable goals can be helpful for your job search process.

2: Network, Network, Network

At its core, networking is about forming authentic connections. It involves getting to know people on a personal level, understanding their skills, experiences, and aspirations, and finding common ground. These relationships are nurtured through genuine conversations, mutual respect, and the willingness to help one another. Networking is a powerful tool for career development, enabling individuals to establish meaningful connections that can lead to various opportunities. In terms of the job search process, Networking can be helpful because " Research shows that 70% of all jobs are not published publicly on jobs sites and as much as 80% of jobs are filled through personal and professional connections."

There are many ways to network effectively: attending career fairs and professional events, actively nurturing professional relationships, and maintaining an active presence on [LinkedIn](#). LinkedIn is a Networking tool that allows you to connect with classmates, professors, or colleagues to expand your professional circle. Building and maintaining these professional connections can open doors to opportunities you may not have found otherwise. Our [LinkedIn Guide](#) can assist you in utilizing this resource to its fullest potential.

3: Stay Organized

One of the most difficult parts of the job search process is staying organized. It is important to keep track of the jobs you've applied for, the recruiters and employers you've connected with and their contact information, potential leads to pursue, and any follow up that needs to be had. There are several ways to stay organized. You can create an excel spreadsheet, notebook, folder, or a working document to track application data, due dates, contact information, and more. Staying organized can help you make the most of this journey.

4: Learn From Each Rejection You've Had

Rejection is a common part of the job search process, and as difficult it can be to navigate, it is a valuable learning experience. It is important to approach rejection with a positive mindset. There are several ways to navigate rejection constructively:

- You can ask for feedback from interviewers if possible and/or appropriate to identify areas for personal improvement.
- You can review your application materials and interview performance to make adjustments as needed.
- You can reflect on your interview performance to determine the efficacy of your strategy
- Keeping a positive mindset can be essential to your ability to navigate rejection

Every rejection is a step toward the right opportunity, and persistence is key to making the most of this journey.

5: Disconnect and Prioritize Self Care

In the midst of all the stress and challenges of the process, it is important to take care of yourself. Self-care is different for each person and can include:

- Taking a break
- Reading a book
- Exercise or physical activity
- Spend time in nature
- Nurture your hobbies
- Spend quality time with friends/family/relatives/people you love
- Practice mindfulness

Recognizing when you need a break and allowing yourself the time to rest can prevent burnout. A well-rested mind is more productive and resilient during the job search journey.

6: Celebrate the Small Victories

In a process filled with rejections and challenges, it is important for you to celebrate every win and your progress along the way. Whether it's perfecting your resume, landing an interview, expanding your network, improving your interview skills, or gaining valuable feedback about your personal brand can be seen as a win. Recognizing your victories, no matter how small, helps keep you motivated and reminds you that your efforts are paying off. Celebrating the process can help keep you motivated amidst all the challenges and can ultimately help the process.

7: Connect with Career Services Professionals

The Center for Career Readiness and Life Skills provides services and resources to support you in your career development process. You can [schedule in-person and virtual appointments](#) with our Career Coaches. All of these services are offered during your enrollment as a UConn student including up to 3 years after you graduate.

By Ellenese Espaillat



Office Hours: 8AM – 5PM
Career Coaching Hours: 8AM – 5PM
** Evening appointments vary by semester.*

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